

Remote Work and the Gender Wage Gap

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Research Question & Hypotheses

Research Question: Does remote work narrow the gender wage gap, and does education amplify that effect?

H1

Remote work is associated with a larger wage premium for women than men, because it reduces caregiving, commute, and schedule barriers that disproportionately constrain women.

H2

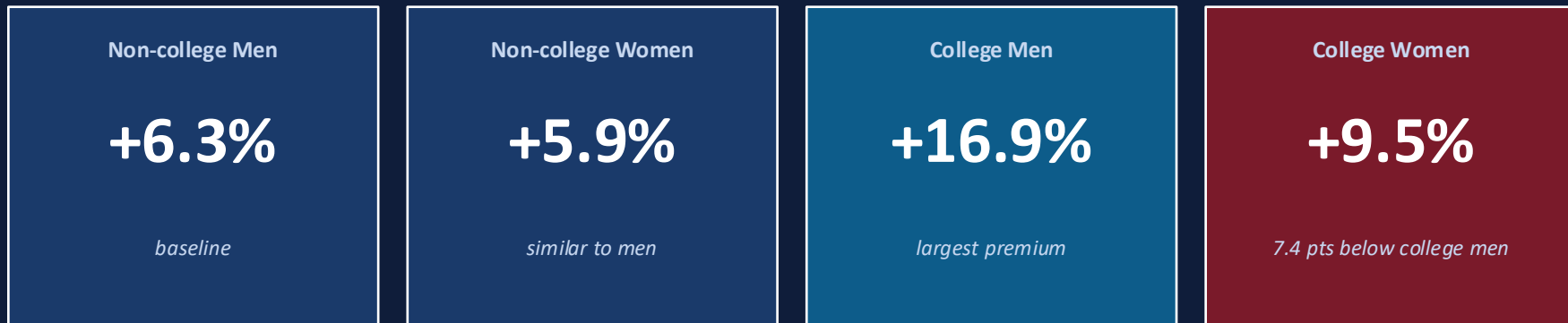
College-educated women are expected to gain the most from remote work, as it removes barriers while keeping them competitive for high-skill, high-paying positions.

Regression Results

- Model 1, the baseline: remote times female is -0.083, significant at the 1% level. In the raw data women actually get less of the remote premium than men
- Model 2 adds human capital controls: college, experience, experience squared, and union membership. The coefficient shrinks to -0.042, still significant
- Model 3: adds the full interaction set plus occupation and industry fixed effects. For non-college educated workers, the coefficient drops to -0.004 and is no longer significant.

	(1) Model 1	(2) Model 2	(3) Model 3
remote	0.346*** (0.019)	0.207*** (0.017)	0.065*** (0.021)
female	-0.124*** (0.006)	-0.136*** (0.005)	-0.083*** (0.007)
remote_x_female	-0.083*** (0.022)	-0.042** (0.020)	-0.004 (0.024)
college		0.302*** (0.008)	0.116*** (0.011)
exper		0.022*** (0.001)	0.011*** (0.001)
exper_sq		-0.000*** (0.000)	-0.000*** (0.000)
union_member		0.189*** (0.009)	0.124*** (0.008)
remote_x_college			0.104*** (0.032)
female_x_college			0.033*** (0.015)
remote_x_female_college			-0.070* (0.039)
hours usually work-t			0.004*** (0.000)
R-squared	0.052	0.206	0.435
F-statistic	390.496	730.902	.
Prob > F	0.000	0.000	.

Findings & Conclusion



- Remote work closes the gender wage gap for non-college-educated workers - men +6.3%, women +5.9%.
- Among college-educated workers, men capture nearly twice the remote premium that women do - +16.9% vs +9.5%.
- Education is the amplifier, not gender. The remote premium grows substantially with college, but that gain flows disproportionately to men.
- Goldin (2014) predicted remote work would reduce the cost of inflexible schedules for women. The data suggest it does, but only outside of high-skill roles.